

Business Data Analytics — PREVIEW

Course: CPA — Certified Public Accountant | **Level:** Advanced Level (CA35P — Practical Paper)

This is a free preview. It shows the unit overview and exam-paper layout used throughout the full document, plus the introduction section.

Unit overview

Unit description. This paper is aimed at enabling a candidate to use information technology to support decision-making through business analytics. It builds the digital competency needed to prepare and analyse financial statements, forecast results, and apply data-driven techniques across the accounting specialisations — financial reporting, financial management, management accounting, auditing, and taxation/public finance.

Prerequisite. A candidate attempting this paper is expected to have passed all other CPA examination papers, with core knowledge of quantitative techniques, financial accounting and reporting, and financial management already secure.

Learning outcomes. A candidate who passes this paper should be able to discuss fundamental aspects of big data and analytics, apply data analytics across financial reporting, financial management, management accounting, auditing, and tax/public finance, and evaluate emerging issues in the field. *(Full learning outcomes list in the full version.)*

Contents (full paper)

1. Data concepts and the data lifecycle — *included in this preview*
2. Big data and types of data analytics — full version only
3. Categories of data-analytics tools — full version only
4. Principles of data visualisation — full version only
5. Data analytics in financial accounting and reporting — full version only
6. Data analytics in financial management — full version only
7. Data analytics in management accounting — full version only
8. Data analytics in auditing — full version only
9. Data analytics in taxation and public financial management — full version only
10. Emerging issues and limitations in data analytics — full version only

11. Full worked question — regression-based cost estimation and break-even — full version only
 12. Practice examination — KASNEB-style paper — *Question One shown below; Questions Two–Five full version only*
 13. Marking guide — model answers to the practice examination — full version only
 14. Exam technique and revision checklist — full version only
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1. Data concepts and the data lifecycle

Data can be described at three levels: a **conceptual data model** describes, in business terms, what entities matter and how they relate; a **logical data model** adds structure without committing to a specific technology; a **physical data model** specifies exactly how data is stored in a given system. Data moves through a lifecycle: identifying sources, modelling requirements, obtaining, recording, using, and eventually removing data.

Sample of the practice examination (Question One of Five)

Note on format. The full paper includes a complete practice examination laid out the way a real KASNEB CPA paper is laid out — timed, five compulsory 20-mark questions — so you can rehearse the exact exam format before sitting the real thing. This is an original practice paper, **not a reproduction of any actual KASNEB past paper.**

CPA ADVANCED LEVEL — BUSINESS DATA ANALYTICS (PRACTICE PAPER)

TIME ALLOWED: 3 HOURS

Instructions to candidates: Answer ALL FIVE questions. Each question carries 20 marks. Show all workings clearly.

QUESTION ONE

- (a) Distinguish between a conceptual, a logical and a physical data model. (9 marks)
- (b) Outline the stages of the data lifecycle. (8 marks)
- (c) Define "big data." (3 marks)

(Total: 20 marks)

Questions Two, Three, Four and Five — plus the full marking guide with model answers to all five questions — are in the full version.

Unlock the full paper

The complete version includes big data and analytics types, data-analytics tools, visualisation principles, applications across financial reporting, financial management, management accounting, auditing and tax/public finance, emerging issues, a fully worked regression cost-estimation question, the complete five-question KASNEB-style practice examination with a full marking guide, and an exam technique and revision checklist.

Purchase the full paper to continue.